STUDENT READ-AHEAD · WEEK 4 LIVE LAB

SIGNAL LOST

"OPERATION UPLINK" · READ THIS BEFORE CLASS

Saboteurs cut the station's uplink overnight. Four subsystems, four fragments, one beacon — and Docker ships next week on this wire.

WED AUG 12 · 6:00–8:00 PM · ZOOM · SETUP REQUIRED BEFORE CLASS

The mission: saboteurs hit Relay Station 4 overnight and cut its uplink. Four subsystems — the Antenna Array, the Relay Rack, the Log Archive, the Crew Deck — each hold **one fragment** of the console's restart sequence. Recover all four, arm the console, and fire three test packets at the beacon: three echoes home and the uplink lives. **Every station is solvable with commands from Monday's labs 01:07–10.** Some clues sit in files; some are *running*, hiding in the machine itself. Read the station — it always tells you.

DO THIS BEFORE 6:00 PM — REQUIRED

1. Download `setup.sh` from D2L (Week 4 → Operation Uplink)
2. Run it: `bash setup.sh` — as yourself, **never** with sudo (this game never asks for a password)
3. Verify: `ls ~/uplink-hunt` shows **four station folders**
4. Pre-flight: `sudo apt install -y dnsutils` (lab 01:07's dig)
5. **Don't go in yet** — exploring early cheats you out of the race

BRING TO CLASS

- Laptop + charger + **working internet** — the finale IS an internet check
- Monday's notes — tonight is **open-notes**; page 2 is a legal cheat sheet
- Labs 01:07–10 finished if possible — the game assumes those muscles
- Setup didn't work? Arrive at **6:00 sharp** — that's the fix-it window

HOW THE HUNT WORKS

CREWS

2 PER CREW

Each pair gets its own Zoom breakout room and races every other crew. Your crew clears a station only when **both of you** hold its fragment.

ROLES

SWAP EVERY STATION

Driver shares screen and types while narrating · **Navigator** reads the briefings aloud and calls the next command. Swap at every station door — you each drive twice.

RULE #1

BOTH MUST FIRE

Everything runs on your **own machine**. Coach with words only — never type on your partner's keyboard. The final banner must come from **both terminals**.

SCORING

- Post clears to main Zoom chat: `CREW 3 — Station 2 clear (2/2)`
- Winner: first crew with **both** victory banners in main chat
- Tiebreaker: fewest hint tokens · winners pick the debrief topic

HINTS

- Your crew has **3 hint tokens** for the night (Zoom "Ask for Help" summons the instructor)
- Unlimited free hint, always the same: **read the briefing again — or read what your last command printed**
- The station talks back: when something doesn't work, it prints *why*. Read the message before asking

TONIGHT · SCHEDULE

CLOCK	BLOCK	WHAT HAPPENS
6:00	**Check-in**	✓ in chat when `ls ~/uplink-hunt` shows four stations · setup rescue · crews assigned
6:05	**The hunt**	60:00 on the clock · breakouts open · leaderboard + milestone broadcasts in main
7:05	**Debrief**	Banners tallied · crews teach the stations back · one number was hiding in plain sight
7:15	**Phase-gate**	**Module 01 phase-gate (01:11)** — timed, no-help, from memory
7:55	**Close**	Labs 01:07–11 due Sunday · Week 5: Docker arrives over the link you restored

4	60:00	2	01:11
STATIONS	ON THE CLOCK	PER CREW	PHASE-GATE AFTER

TRAIN BEFORE TONIGHT — THE SIX UPLINK SKILLS

If you can do these six things, you can restore the uplink. Each one comes straight from a Monday lab. Rusty on any? Re-run that lab this afternoon — that's the whole read-ahead assignment.

#	CAN YOU…	PRACTICE COMMANDS	FROM LAB
1	Find your machine's own network addresses	`ip a`	01:07
2	List every port your machine is listening on	`ss -tuln`	01:07
3	Turn a name into an address — and fetch a URL	`dig +short example.com · curl`	01:07
4	Find one process in a crowded process table	`ps aux | grep name`	01:08
5	Chain a counting pipeline, stage by stage	`grep | cut -d: -f1 | sort | uniq -c`	01:09
6	Read your own line of the user manifest	`grep $USER /etc/passwd · cut -d: -f7`	01:09–10

Skill 5 is the boss fight. Practice saying the pipeline out loud, left to right: *"grep keeps the matching lines · cut slices out one field · sort lines them up · uniq -c counts the repeats."* If you can narrate that sentence, the Log Archive will not stop you — and the same pipeline is waiting on the **phase-gate at 7:15**.

RULES OF THE STATION

FAIR PLAY

- Don't enter `~/uplink-hunt` before the hunt starts
- The `.machinery` bay is **sealed** — snooping in it voids your completion code
- Coach your partner with **words only** — never type on their machine, never paste an answer
- No web searches needed or allowed — **everything is in the stations** and on this page
- Notes, this handout, and your lab files: all legal

SAFETY

- Everything happens inside `~/uplink-hunt/` — the game never asks you to touch anything outside it
- **Zero** `rm -r` and **zero sudo** in this game — nothing gets deleted, nothing needs root
- Wrecked something? `bash setup.sh --reset` rebuilds the station fresh in seconds
- Something that should be running has gone quiet? `bash power.sh` restarts the machinery

WHAT "UPLINK RESTORED" LOOKS LIKE

The console prints a victory banner with a **completion code** in your terminal. **Screenshot it and post it in Zoom chat** — that's tonight's participation artifact, and both crew members must post one. Then catch your breath: the phase-gate starts at 7:15, and everything you just typed is on it.

Still owe labs? Tonight IS the review. Everything you type in the hunt is labs 01:07–10 material — finish and submit those plus the phase-gate lesson 01:11 in D2L by **Sunday**. Labs, not attendance, gate your progress to Week 5's Docker install.

LINKS · QUESTIONS

Class sign-in: tktechventure.com/agentic-coding/sign-in · **D2L:** templejc.desire2learn.com · **Course site:** tktechventure.com/agentic-coding
Setup trouble before class? Post in the course channel or email **contact@tktechventure.com** — don't wait until 6:00 to say so.